

Programming languages which celebrated golden jubilee

C was first developed in 1972. In 2022, it will celebrate the golden jubilee of its service to mankind — an event worth celebrating. But do remember that there are even older programming languages in the world. Let us discuss a few of these that are still relevant today, and appear in the top 50 at least of any one of the programming language rankings, despite celebrating their golden jubilee of existence in the programming world. Of course, assembly language is one of the oldest languages that is still surviving. In fact, it has not only survived but is making an impact on the programming world even today. Wikipedia says assembly languages first appeared in 1949. Assembly languages are ranked 11th and 15th in two rankings. Notice that, even though machine languages predate assembly languages, they are not listed in any of the rankings. COBOL, which came into existence in 1959, is still ranked 26th, 31st, and 43rd in three rankings. Fortran, which came into existence in 1957, is ranked 25th and 30th in two rankings. A surprise entry in this list is Forth, first introduced in 1970. Though not very popular at any point in time, this language is ranked 47th in one of the rankings. I haven't included Pascal in this list, because only Object Pascal, not as old as Pascal, is mentioned in the rankings. I also haven't included Lisp in this list, because so many of the dialects of Lisp, like Racket, Scheme, Clojure, etc, are treated as independent programming languages and ranked separately. But do remember that this language, which came into existence in 1958, is still very influential. So, our list of golden jubilee celebrating influential programming languages includes assembly languages, COBOL, Fortran, and Forth.

Now, let us also discuss certain programming languages that are extinct despite holding a lot of promise in their time. By extinct, I only mean that I couldn't find them in the top 50 in any of the rankings. Remember, the programming languages mentioned in this list are still relevant historically. The first language that comes to my mind is ALGOL, which came into existence in 1958 and is not important any more. Simula, which was released in 1962 and had influenced the development of object-oriented programming languages like C++, no longer plays any important role in the programming world. PL/I (Programming Language One), developed by IBM in 1964, was once used widely but that's not so any more. APL, which came into existence in 1966, was a promising programming language once, but is almost extinct now. Since Object Pascal is mentioned in two rankings, I haven't included Pascal in this list. So, our final list of once prominent but now extinct programming languages includes ALGOL, Simula, PL/I, and APL. But I am certain that I have failed to include quite a number of influential languages in this list.

The Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2020

Now it is time to wind up our discussion. But any article detailing the current trends in the programming world is incomplete without mentioning the Stack Overflow Developer Surveys. The four popular programming language ranking schemes which this article relies on are more or less computer generated, based on data like number of Google

searches, number of searches for online tutorials, etc. The Stack Overflow Developer Survey, on the other hand, depends on opinion polls conducted with developers all over the world. The 2020 Developer Survey was answered by more than 65,000 developers. Let us try to get some insights from it.

According to the latest survey, the three most 'loved' programming languages are Rust, TypeScript, and Python — in that order. The term 'loved' here means an interest to continue developing with a particular programming language. The same survey points out that the three most 'dreaded' programming languages are VBA, Objective-C, and Perl — in that order. The term 'dreaded' here means lack of interest in continuing the development with a particular programming language. Notice that this matches with our earlier prediction that the future of Objective-C and Perl may not be very bright. The survey also says that the three most 'wanted' programming languages are Python, JavaScript, and Go -- in that order. The term 'wanted' here means an interest in learning afresh and adopting a particular programming language. This again matches with our earlier prediction that the future of Python seems very bright. I have only mentioned the top three entries in each category but a detailed list is available online. The survey also features the most 'loved', 'dreaded', and 'wanted' frameworks, tools, databases, etc. I urge you to go through the latest Stack Overflow Developer Survey available online, and assure you the time spent exploring it will be aptly rewarded.  **END**

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